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(FROM LEFT) CHEERLEADERS
RULE; ANIL KUMBLE AND
MARK BOUCHER CELEBRATE;
(BELOW) WINNERS OF THE
KOCHI FRANCHISE REJOICE

IPL'S SUCCESS, SOME EXPERTS

SAY, IS NOT DEPENDENT ON
CONSISTENT QUICK PROFITS BUT
ON THE VERY IDEA OF GROWTH.



Courtesy: MALAYALA MANORAMA

Modi told INDIA TODAY that the new teams, "need to understand that the model we have built is very different from all other models in the world. They need to embrace it and not only think of their team but of the whole league as one. Once that realisation sets in—it will be win-win for all."

As the new teams scramble, Modi will continue to venture further. New media rights such as live streaming on mobiles, mobile Internet, mobile score-cards and smart phone applications, which he hopes will explode once 3G technology is introduced in India. He also hopes to tap international audience, changing the IPL's platform in the UK in Season 3 from the bankrupt Setanta to free-on-air ITV 4.

Yet it is not always about the money. For Kingfisher, the premium is a pittance compared to the ban on liquor advertising Vijay Mallya is circumventing. For GMR, the association with a city whose new international airport they are racing to complete before the Commonwealth Games is worth the \$84 million they paid for the Daredevils. At a board meeting of India Cements, who own the Chennai Super Kings (named after the Super Kings cement brand), consensus was that owning a franchise was worth the cost when treated like a brand marketing expense.

The IPL is also turning out to be a party for the wives and children. Whether it is young Siddharth Mallya whose romantic assignations are now conducted on national TV or Gayatri Reddy who switches from a serious journalistic career at her father's newspaper to hang out with global celebrities at the IPL auction, the league is the ultimate celebuntante ball. For largely unemployed actors such as Shilpa Shetty of the Rajasthan Royals and Preity Zinta of Kings XI Punjab, it is unprecedented and unpaid publicity.

No wonder ship-breakers, diamond dealers and real estate magnates teamed up to buy the Kochi franchise. "I'm just a businessman and